

Absolutely — **float** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it in an artistic, visual sense:

> “...the blurred reflections, and the quiet, **floating light**.”

Here **floating** does **not** literally mean that light is physically buoyant on water. It suggests that the light seems to **rest, drift, or hover gently over the water without heaviness or fixed boundaries**.

Word family: **float / floating / flotation**

Base word: float

Verb forms: float, floats, floated, floating

Noun: float

Related noun: flotation / floatation

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / participial adjective (分詞形容詞)

Meaning in your passage: **floating = seeming to hover or drift lightly — 彷彿漂浮的；輕柔浮動的**

Your phrase:

> “...the quiet, **floating light**.”

Here **floating** means:

> **appearing to rest or move gently over the surface without seeming fixed or heavy.**

繁體中文：

看起來像輕輕停留、漂移在水面上，沒有明確固定位置或沉重感的

Natural translation:

> “the quiet, floating light”

「那種寧靜、**彷彿輕輕漂浮在水面上的光影**」

So here:

> **floating = 輕柔浮動 / 彷彿漂浮的**

It is an **artistic figurative extension** of literal floating.

1. **float = stay on the surface of a liquid — 漂浮；浮在水面**

The core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “The leaves **floated** on the pond.”

「樹葉**漂浮在池塘水面上**。」

Practice 2

> “Oil floats on water.”

「油會**浮在水面上**。」

****float = 因浮力而停留在液體表面或其中，而不沉下去****

2. **float = move gently on water — 漂流；漂動**

Here the emphasis is movement rather than simply staying afloat.

Practice 3

> “A small boat **floated** slowly across the lake.”

「一艘小船慢慢地在湖面上**漂行**。」

Practice 4

> “Petals floated downstream.”

「花瓣順流**漂去**。」

****float = 在水面上隨水流或輕微力量緩慢移動****

This is closely related to #1, so conceptually they belong to the same physical family.

3. **float = remain/move in air — 飄浮；飄動**

A major extension from water to air.

Practice 5

> “A feather **floated** through the air.”

「一根羽毛在空中**飄動**。」

Practice 6

> “Dust floated in the sunlight.”

「灰塵在陽光中**飄浮**。」

float = 某物在空氣中輕輕停留或移動，不迅速落下

4. **floating** = visually seeming to hover/drift — 彷彿漂浮的；輕柔浮動的

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 7 — Original

> “I noticed the quiet, **floating light**.”

「我留意到那種寧靜、**彷彿漂浮著的光影**。」

Practice 8

> “Soft patches of light seemed to float across the water.”

「柔和的光影彷彿在水面上**輕輕漂動**。」

floating — artistic/figurative = 看起來沒有固定重量或邊界，像在空間 / 表面上輕輕漂移

5. **float** = move lightly and gracefully — 輕盈地移動；飄然而行

A common figurative movement sense.

Practice 9

> “She seemed to **float** across the stage.”

「她彷彿**輕盈地飄過**舞台。」

Practice 10

> “The dancer floated into the room.”

「舞者**輕盈地走進**房間。」

****float = 以非常輕盈、流暢、幾乎沒有重量感的方式移動****

Not literal buoyancy.

6. ****float = drift without a fixed direction or position — 漂蕩；遊移****

A broader figurative extension.

Practice 11

> “Clouds ****floated**** across the sky.”

「雲朵在天空中**飄過**。」

Practice 12

> “His attention floated from one topic to another.”

「他的注意力在不同話題之間**游移**。」

****float = 沒有明確固定方向或位置地緩慢移動 / 轉移****

7. ****float an idea / proposal = put it forward for discussion — 提出想法；拋出建議****

A very important figurative verb sense.

Practice 13

> “She ****floated**** the idea of opening the exhibition later.”

「她**提出了**把展覽延後開放的想法。」

Practice 14

> “Several possible solutions were floated at the meeting.”

「會議上有人**提出**了幾個可能的解決方案。」

float + idea/proposal = 把一個尚未正式決定的想法提出來，看看別人的反應

This often implies:

> tentative / exploratory proposal

8. **float a company / shares (金融) — 使公司上市；公開發售股票**

A major business/finance meaning, especially BrE.

Practice 15

> “The owners plan to **float** the company next year.”

「公司持有人計劃明年讓公司**上市**。」

Practice 16

> “The firm was floated on the stock market.”

「這家公司已在股票市場**上市**。」

float — finance/business = 把私人公司的股份公開出售，使公司在證券市場上市

Register: especially BrE.

9. **float a currency = allow exchange value to move freely — 讓貨幣浮動**

A distinct economic meaning.

Practice 17

> “The government decided to **float** the currency.”

「政府決定讓該貨幣的匯率**自由浮動**。」

Practice 18

> “The currency was allowed to float against the dollar.”

「該貨幣獲准兌美元**浮動**。」

float — currency = 不把匯率固定在特定水平，而讓市場供求決定其價值

10. **floating exchange rate = 浮動匯率**

A common economic compound.

Practice 19

> “The country uses a **floating exchange rate**.”

「該國採用**浮動匯率制度**。」

Practice 20

> “A floating exchange rate changes with market conditions.”

「**浮動匯率**會隨市場情況改變。」

floating exchange rate = 匯率主要由市場供求決定，而不是固定在某個水平

11. **float = noun, decorated vehicle/platform in a parade — 花車；巡遊彩車**

A completely distinct noun meaning.

Practice 21

> “The parade included a huge flower-covered **float**.”

「巡遊中有一輛大型鮮花**花車**。」

Practice 22

> “Children waved from the festival float.”

「孩子們從節慶**花車**上向人揮手。」

float — parade = 巡遊時經過裝飾、載人或展示主題的車輛 / 平台

Excellent MCQ contrast.

12. **float = noun, buoyant object used in fishing — 浮標；魚漂**

A common practical noun sense.

Practice 23

> “Watch the **float** carefully for movement.”

「仔細留意**魚漂 / 浮標**有沒有動。」

Practice 24

> “The float disappeared beneath the water.”

「**魚漂**沉到水面下。」

float — fishing = 放在線上的浮水裝置，用來顯示魚是否咬餌

13. **float = buoyant device controlling liquid level — 浮球；浮子**

A technical/mechanical noun sense.

Practice 25

> “The tank uses a **float** to control the water level.”

「水箱利用**浮球**控制水位。」

Practice 26

> “A damaged float can cause the tank to overflow.”

「**浮球**損壞可能令水箱溢水。」

float — mechanism = 隨液面升降的浮動裝置，用來測量或控制液體水平

14. **float = small reserve of cash — 備用現金；零用找續金**

A common business/retail noun sense, especially BrE.

Practice 27

> “The cashier starts the day with a £100 **float**.”

「收銀員每天開始工作時會有 100 英鎊的**找續備用現金**。」

Practice 28

> “Make sure there is enough change in the float.”

「確保**收銀備用金**裡有足夠零錢。」

float — retail = 收銀處預先準備、用來找續的小額現金

Register: especially BrE.

15. **float** = shares available for public trading — 公眾持股；**流通股**

Another finance noun meaning.

Practice 29

> “Only a small percentage of the company’s shares are in the public **float**.”

「該公司只有小部分股份屬於**公眾流通股**。」

Practice 30

> “A larger float can increase trading liquidity.”

「較多的**流通股份**可以提高交易流動性。」

float — stock market = 可由公眾在市場自由買賣的公司股份數量 / 比例

This is more technical than “float a company,” but useful in business English.

16. **floating** = not fixed / able to change — 浮動的；不固定的

A broad adjective sense derived from the verb.

Practice 31

> “The loan has a **floating interest rate**.”

「這筆貸款採用**浮動利率**。」

Practice 32

> “They use a floating schedule rather than fixed hours.”

「他們採用**彈性 / 非固定時間表**，而不是固定工時。」

floating = 數值、位置、時間或安排不是固定不變，而可以變動

17. **floating interest rate = 浮動利率**

A major financial compound.

Practice 33

> “Payments may rise if the **floating interest rate** increases.”

「如果**浮動利率**上升，還款額可能增加。」

Practice 34

> “The mortgage has a floating rate.”

「這筆按揭採用**浮動利率**。」

floating interest rate = 會隨市場基準或其他條件調整的利率

18. **floating population (社會 / 人口) — 流動人口**

A useful institutional compound.

Practice 35

> “The city has a large **floating population**.”

「這座城市有大量**流動人口**。」

Practice 36

> “The study examined housing needs among the floating population.”

「研究檢視了**流動人口**的住房需求。」

floating population = 經常流動、暫住而沒有固定長期居住於當地的人口

Register: formal/demographic.

19. **float = noun, ice-cream drink — 冰淇淋汽水**

A common AmE food meaning.

Practice 37

> “He ordered a root beer **float**.”

「他點了一杯**根啤冰淇淋汽水**。」

Practice 38

> “The café serves cola floats in summer.”

「這間咖啡店夏天供應可樂**冰淇淋汽水**。」

float — drink = 把一球或多球冰淇淋放進汽水中的飲品

Especially AmE.

20. **flotation / floatation = floating or making something float — 漂浮；浮選 / 浮力處理**

A related noun.

Practice 39

> “The device provides enough **flotation** to keep the swimmer above water.”

「這個裝置提供足夠的**浮力 / 漂浮力**，令泳者保持在水面上。」

Practice 40

> “Flotation devices are stored under the seats.”

「座位下方存放著**漂浮救生裝置**。」

****flotation = 漂浮的狀態，或使人 / 物保持漂浮的作用****

****flotation** is the more common spelling; ****floatation**** also exists.**

Important distinction: ****float vs swim****

****float****

= stay/move on water without necessarily actively propelling oneself.

****swim****

= actively move through water using body movements.

> “He floated on his back.”

= 他仰躺**漂浮**在水面。

> “He swam across the lake.”

= 他**游過**湖。

Important distinction: ****float vs drift****

****float****

emphasizes being supported by water/air or moving lightly.

****drift****

emphasizes movement caused by currents/wind, usually without deliberate control.

> “The leaf floated on the water.”

= 葉子浮在水上。

> “The leaf drifted downstream.”

= 葉子隨水流漂向下游。

They often overlap.

Important distinction: **float vs hover**

float

= gently remain/move in water or air, often without fixed position.

hover

= remain almost in one position in the air or near a surface.

> balloon floating in the sky

> = 氣球在天空飄浮

> helicopter hovering above the building

> = 直升機在建築物上方盤旋 / 懸停

For your passage, **floating light** gives a softer, drifting impression than **hovering light**.

Important distinction: **float vs fly**

fly

usually involves active/controlled movement through air.

float

suggests light, gentle, often passive movement.

> bird flies

> = 鳥飛翔

> feather floats

> = 羽毛飄浮

Important distinction: **float vs sink**

Direct physical opposites.

float

= remain on/near the surface.

sink

= move downward below the surface.

> Wood floats.

> Heavy metal may sink.

So:

> float = 浮

> sink = 沉

Important distinction: **float vs floating in your passage**

Your phrase:

> “floating light”

does **not** mean:

> light is literally an object physically floating on water.

It is artistic language describing light that seems:

* soft

* weightless

* gently mobile

* loosely resting on the water

Therefore:

> **「浮動的光影 / 彷彿漂浮的光線」**

is better than mechanically translating it as:

> 「漂浮的燈光」

Important distinction: **float an idea vs decide**

float an idea

= tentatively put it forward.

decide

= reach a conclusion.

> “She floated the idea of moving the exhibition.”

= 她先提出這個想法供大家討論。

It does **not** mean the decision has been made.

Important distinction: **float a company vs float a currency**

Same verb, different financial operations:

Company

> float a company

> = 使公司上市

Currency

> float a currency

> = 讓匯率由市場浮動

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **floating vs fixed**

A useful general contrast.

floating

= able to vary.

fixed

= set and not changing.

Examples:

> floating exchange rate

> = 浮動匯率

> fixed exchange rate

> = 固定匯率

> floating interest rate

> = 浮動利率

> fixed interest rate

> = 固定利率

Important distinction: **float — parade vs float — fishing**

Same noun, completely different objects:

> parade float

> = 巡遊花車

> fishing float

> = 魚漂 / 浮標

Very strong MCQ material.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **float — on liquid** = 漂浮

* **float — move on water** = 漂流 / 漂動

* **float — in air** = 飄浮 / 飄動

* **floating — artistic visual** = 彷彿漂浮 / 輕柔浮動的

* **float — graceful movement** = 輕盈移動

* **float — drift figuratively** = 漂蕩 / 游移

* **float an idea** = 提出想法供討論

* **float a company** = 使公司上市

* **float a currency** = 讓貨幣匯率浮動

* **floating exchange rate** = 浮動匯率

* **float — parade** = 花車
 * **float — fishing** = 魚漂 / 浮標
 * **float — mechanism** = 浮球 / 浮子
 * **float — retail cash** = 找續備用金
 * **float — shares** = 公眾流通股
 * **floating — variable** = 浮動 / 不固定的
 * **floating interest rate** = 浮動利率
 * **floating population** = 流動人口
 * **float — drink** = 冰淇淋汽水
 * **flotation** = 漂浮 / 浮力作用

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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float — liquid	因浮力而停留在液體表面 / 其中，而不沉下去
float — water movement	在水面上隨水流或輕微力量緩慢漂動
float — air	在空氣中輕輕停留或移動
floating — artistic	看起來沒有重量感或固定位置，彷彿輕輕漂移的
float — graceful movement	以非常輕盈、流暢、幾乎沒有重量感的方式移動
float — figurative drift	沒有明確固定方向地緩慢移動 / 轉移
float an idea	把尚未正式決定的想法提出來供討論 / 試探反應
float a company	把私人公司的股份公開出售，使公司上市
float a currency	讓匯率由市場供求決定，而不是維持固定水平
floating exchange rate	主要由市場供求決定的浮動匯率
float — parade	巡遊中經裝飾的花車 / 展示平台
float — fishing	浮在線上、顯示魚是否咬餌的魚漂
float — mechanism	隨液面升降、用來控制或測量液面的浮球 / 浮子
float — retail	收銀處預備用來找續的小額現金
float — shares	可由公眾自由買賣的公司流通股份
floating — variable	數值、安排或位置可以改變而非固定的
floating interest rate	會隨市場基準或條件調整的利率
floating population	經常流動 / 暫住而非固定長期居住的人口
float — drink	加入冰淇淋的汽水飲品
flotation	保持漂浮或使人 / 物漂浮的狀態 / 作用

For your original phrase

> “...the blurred reflections, and the quiet, **floating light**.”

The exact meaning is:

floating = Monet 畫中的光線 / 光影看起來柔和、輕盈，彷彿沒有重量地停留或緩慢漂移在水面上

Natural translation:

> **「那些朦朧的倒影，以及寧靜、彷彿在水面上輕輕浮動的光影。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **float on water** → 漂浮在水面
- > **float in the air** → 在空中飄浮
- > **floating light** → 彷彿輕柔漂浮的光影
- > **float gracefully** → 輕盈地移動
- > **float an idea** → 提出想法供討論
- > **float a company** → 使公司上市
- > **float a currency** → 讓貨幣匯率浮動
- > **parade float** → 巡遊花車
- > **fishing float** → 魚漂
- > **cash float** → 收銀找續備用金
- > **floating rate** → 浮動利率 / 匯率